

أَعُوذُ بِاللَّهِ مِنَ الشَّيْطَانِ الرَّجِيمِ

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

Lisan ul Quran — Lecture 13 and 14

Jumla Ismiyyah · Muftada and Khabar

1. Lafz, Kalimah and Ism at a glance

Every utterance that leaves a person's mouth, purposeful or otherwise, is called a **lafz**. A meaningful **lafz** is a **Kalimah** and a meaningless one is **Muhmal**. No word used in the Qur'an is meaningless; every word is a **Kalimah**, which is to say it is either an **Ism**, or a **Fi'l**, or a **Harf**.

Kind	Definition	Example
Ism	The name of a person, place, thing, quality or action	زَيْدٌ ، مَسْجِدٌ ، انْفَاقٌ
Fi'l	A Kalimah in which the doing or occurring of an action is found together with some tense	نَصَرَ
Harf	A Kalimah that gives no complete meaning on its own but serves to join an Ism and a Fi'l	فِي ، عَلَى ، إِلَى

The **Ism** has three outward marks: **Al** at the beginning (as in اَلْحَمْدُ), **Tanween** at the end (as in كِتَابٌ), and a round taa' at the end (as in جَنَّةٌ). If even one of these is present, the word is an **Ism**.

2. The four aspects of an Ism

To use any noun correctly in an Arabic sentence, its four aspects must be known.

Aspect	Its forms	Examples and explanation
Jins	Mudhakkar , Mu'annath	رَجُلٌ (a man) is Mudhakkar, and اِمْرَأَةٌ (a woman) is Mu'annath.
'Adad	Wahid , Tathniyah , Jam'	A Tathniyah is recognised by the aani or ayni sound at the end. The Jam' is of two kinds: Jam' Salim, in which the letters stay sound, and Jam' Mukassar, in which the shape breaks up.
Wus'at	Ma'rifah , Nakirah	A Ma'rifah is the name of some particular person, place or thing, and a Nakirah of something general.

Aspect	Its forms	Examples and explanation
I'raab	Marfoo' , Mansoob , Majroor	The state of raf' is the subject state of a noun, the state of nasb the object state, and the state of jarr expresses annexation or possession.

3. The states of I'raab of the various nouns in summary

Kind	Marfoo'	Mansoob	Majroor
Singular and Jam' Mukassar (Munsarif)	كِتَابٌ	كِتَابًا	كِتَابٍ
The same, with al-	الْكِتَابُ	الْكِتَابَ	الْكِتَابِ
Ghayr Munsarif	إِبْرَاهِيمُ	إِبْرَاهِيمَ	إِبْرَاهِيمِ
Tathniyah	حَافِظَانِ	حَافِظَيْنِ	حَافِظَيْنِ
Jam' Salim Mudhakkar	مُسْلِمُونَ	مُسْلِمِينَ	مُسْلِمِينَ
Jam' Salim Mu'annath	مُسْلِمَاتٌ	مُسْلِمَاتٍ	مُسْلِمَاتٍ

- In the state of **nasb** an alif is added along with the two zabar, but if the noun ends in a round taa' or in an alif with a hamzah, no alif is written and only the **Tanween** appears.
- **Ghayr Munsarif** nouns never take **Tanween** or a kasrah. But once **alif lam** comes at their beginning, they do accept a kasrah in the state of **jarr**.
- Nouns ending in an alif or an **Alif Maqsurah**, such as **مُوسَى** and **عِيسَى**, are written and read in one and the same way in all three states.

4. Mufrad and Murakkab

When a noun stands alone, apart from any sentence, verse or hadith, it is called a **Mufrad Ism**, whether it is **Wahid**, **Tathniyah** or **Jam'** — as in **حَافِظٌ ، حَافِظَانِ ، حَافِظُونَ**. And when two or more **Mufrad** words are written together, the result is called a **Murakkab**.

Kind	Definition	Examples
Murakkab Naqis	A combination of two or more words from which the idea is not complete	a good boy , in the book , the boy's book , this book
Murakkab Tamm	A combination of two or more words from which the idea is	the boy is righteous , this is a book

Kind	Definition	Examples
	complete. This is what is also called a Jumlah.	

Tamm means complete. A **Jumlah** is of two kinds: a **Jumla Ismiyyah** is one that begins with an **Ism**, and a **Jumla Fi'liyyah** is one that begins with a **Fi'l**.

The three ways of forming a sentence

Order	What results	Example
Ism + Ism	Jumla Ismiyyah	زَيْدٌ مُسْلِمٌ
Ism + Fi'l	Jumla Ismiyyah	زَيْدٌ نَصَرَ
Fi'l + Ism	Jumla Fi'liyyah	نَصَرَ زَيْدٌ

Of the three categories of **Kalimah**, only the **Ism** and the **Fi'l** can form a sentence.

5. The parts of a Jumla Ismiyyah: Mubtada and Khabar

Definition: A **Jumla Ismiyyah** is a sentence composed of a **Mubtada** and a **Khabar**, as in زَيْدٌ عَاقِلٌ (Zayd is intelligent).

- The first noun of the sentence is called the **Mubtada**. The word comes from **ibtida'**, beginning, since a **Jumla Ismiyyah** starts with it. It is always **Ma'rifah** and **Marfoo'**.
- The second noun of the sentence is called the **Khabar**, because it gives some information or report about the **Mubtada**. It is generally **Nakirah** and **Marfoo'**.

The technical names: A noun free of governing words is called the **Mubtada** if it is the **Musnad Ilayh**, and the **Khabar** if it is the **Musnad**. That is, that to which the statement is attributed is the **Mubtada**, and the statement attributed is the **Khabar**.

The rule of translation

Rule: In translating a **Jumla Ismiyyah**, the **Mubtada** is rendered first and the **Khabar** after it. Arabic has no separate word for the English "is", "are" or "am"; the very joining of a **Ma'rifah** with a **Nakirah** produces that sense of itself, as in زَيْدٌ مُسْلِمٌ, meaning Zayd is a Muslim.

6. The four conditions for forming a Jumla Ismiyyah

For a **Mubtada** and a **Khabar** to be joined, all four aspects must be in order.

Aspect	Condition	How strictly it holds
Wus'at	The Mubtada is always Ma'rifah and the Khabar Nakirah	Mubtada 100% , Khabar 99%
I'raab	Both nouns are necessarily in the state of raf', that is, Marfoo'	100%
Jins	Both nouns agree in gender — if the Mubtada is Mudhakkar the Khabar is Mudhakkar too	99%
'Adad	Wahid opposite Wahid, Tathniyah opposite Tathniyah, Jam' opposite Jam'	100%

The five categories of Ma'rifah available to the Mubtada

Since the **Mubtada** is always **Ma'rifah**, these five categories of the **Ma'rifah** must be kept in mind:

- **Ism ul 'Alam** — as in زَيْدٌ ، فَاطِمَةُ ، بَاكِسْتَانُ
- **Ism ud Dameer** — as in أَنْتَ ، أَنَا ، نَحْنُ
- **Ism ul Isharah** — as in هَذَا ، تِلْكَ
- **Ism ul Mawsul** — as in الَّذِي ، الَّتِي ، الَّذِينَ
- **Mu'arraaf bil Lam** — as in الْحَمْدُ ، الْمُسْلِمُ

7. Examples: agreement in number and gender

When the Mubtada is singular the Khabar is singular too

Sentence and translation	Mubtada	Khabar
زَيْدٌ مُعَلِّمٌ (Zayd is a teacher)	زَيْدٌ Ma'rifah, Mudhakkar, Marfoo'	مُعَلِّمٌ Nakirah, Mudhakkar, Marfoo'
خَدِيجَةُ صَالِحَةٌ (Khadijah is righteous)	خَدِيجَةُ Ma'rifah, Mu'annath, Marfoo'	صَالِحَةٌ Nakirah, Mu'annath, Marfoo'

When the Mubtada is dual the Khabar is dual too

- زَيْدٌ وَحَامِدٌ مُسْلِمَانِ — Zayd and Hamid are Muslims. The **Mubtada** is two masculine names, so the **Khabar** too has come as a masculine **Tathniyah**.

- خَالِدٌ وَشَاهِدٌ صَالِحَانِ , نَاصِرٌ وَعَابِدٌ صَادِقَانِ
- جِبْرِيلُ وَمِيكَالُ مَلَكَانِ — Jibril and Mika'il are angels. The **Tathniyah** of مَلَكٌ has been used, namely مَلَكَانِ.
- مَرْيَمُ وَزَيْنَبُ مُسْلِمَتَانِ — the **Mubtada** is feminine, so the **Khabar** too has come as a feminine **Tathniyah**, recognised by the sound taani.

When the Mubtada is plural the Khabar is plural too

- دَاوُدُ وَسُلَيْمَنُ وَأَيُّوبُ نَبِيُّونَ / أَنْبِيَاءُ — both the **Jam' Salim** نَبِيُّونَ and the **Jam' Mukassar** أَنْبِيَاءُ are in use for the word Nabi. أَنْبِيَاءُ is **Ghayr Munsarif**, so it takes no **Tanween**.
- مُحَمَّدٌ وَمُوسَى وَعِيسَى رُسُلٌ — the **Jam' Mukassar** of Rasool is رُسُلٌ, which is not **Ghayr Munsarif**, so it does take **Tanween**.
- جِبْرِيلُ وَهَارُوتُ وَمَارُوتُ مَلَائِكَةٌ — the names of angels are **Ghayr Munsarif** and so take no **Tanween**, but the **Khabar** مَلَائِكَةٌ is not **Ghayr Munsarif**, so two pesh have come upon its round taa'.
- عُثْمَانُ وَأَسَامَةُ وَحَامِدٌ طُلَابٌ / طُلَبَاءُ / طَلَبَةٌ — the **Jam' Mukassar** of طَالِبٌ comes in three forms.
- مَرْيَمُ وَزَيْنَبُ وَعَائِشَةُ مُجْتَهِدَاتٌ

The round taa' of Mala'ikah: The word مَلَائِكَةٌ ends in a round taa', which outwardly looks like a mark of the feminine; but it is not there for **ta'neeth** — it belongs to the make-up of the word itself.

When masculine and feminine come together as the Mubtada

Rule: When a masculine and a feminine come together as the **Mubtada**, the **Khabar** comes in the masculine, though the number is still observed. This is the rule of **Taghleeb**, making the masculine prevail over the feminine.

- خَالِدٌ وَزَيْنَبُ صَادِقَانِ
- زَيْنٌ وَمَرْيَمُ صَالِحَانِ
- مَرْيَمُ وَزَيْنَبُ وَشَاهِدٌ جَالِسُونَ
- مَرْيَمُ وَزَيْنَبُ وَعَائِشَةُ وَشَاهِدٌ وَمُعَلِّمُونَ

8. More than one Khabar for a single Muftada

An important rule of Arabic is that a single **Muftada** may have more than one **Khabar**. These may be joined to one another by a waw or left unjoined; both ways are correct.

- Without a waw: زَيْدٌ صَالِحٌ جَمِيلٌ (Zayd is righteous, handsome)
- With a waw: زَيْدٌ صَالِحٌ وَجَمِيلٌ (Zayd is righteous and handsome)
- Three Khabar: زَيْدٌ عَالِمٌ فَاضِلٌ صَالِحٌ

9. Further rulings on the Muftada and the Khabar

9.1 A Nakirah Makhsusah becoming the Muftada

The **Muftada** is usually Ma'rifah and the **Khabar** usually Nakirah. But sometimes a **Nakirah Makhsusah** too becomes the **Muftada** — that is, a **Nakirah** made specific by some quality, as in طِفْلٌ صَغِيرٌ جَمِيلٌ (a small child is beautiful), and likewise رَجُلٌ عَالِمٌ فَاضِلٌ.

9.2 Khabar Muftad and Khabar Jumlah

The **Khabar** of a **Muftada** is sometimes **Muftad** and sometimes a whole sentence. In زَيْدٌ عَالِمٌ the **Khabar** is **Muftad**, whereas in بَكَرٌ يَأْكُلُ الطَّعَامَ the **Khabar** is a complete sentence.

A necessary condition: If the **Khabar** is a sentence, it must contain a pronoun referring back to the **Muftada**, and that pronoun must agree with the **Muftada** in gender and in number.

- زَيْدٌ ضَرَبَ — singular masculine
- الزَّيْدَانِ ضَرَبَا — dual masculine
- الزَّيْدُونَ ضَرَبُوا — plural masculine
- هِنْدٌ ضَرَبَتْ — singular feminine

9.3 The Khabar being a Zarf or a Jarr Majroor

The **Khabar** is sometimes a **Zarf** or a **Jarr Majroor**, as in زَيْدٌ فِي الدَّارِ (Zayd is in the house) and الْكِتَابُ فَوْقَ الدُّوَلَابِ (the book is on top of the cupboard).

- If the governing word of the **Zarf** or **Jarr Majroor** is present in the wording, it is called a **Zarf Laghw**.
- And if it is not present in the wording, it is called a **Zarf Mustaqirr**.

9.4 Khabar Muqaddam and Mubtada Mu'akhkhar

Rule: If a **Zarf** or a **Jarr Majroor** comes at the beginning of a sentence with a noun following it, then that **Zarf** or **Jarr Majroor** is called the **Khabar Muqaddam** and the noun the **Mubtada Mu'akhkhar**, as in **فِي الدَّارِ رَجُلٌ** (in the house is a man).

9.5 An + Fi'l Mudari' becoming the Mubtada

If a **Fi'l Mudari'** comes with **أَنَّ** and is followed by an **Ism Nakirah**, the **Fi'l Mudari'** is interpreted as a **masdar** and made the **Mubtada**, and the **Ism Nakirah** the **Khabar**, as in **وَأَنْ تَصُومُوا خَيْرٌ لَّكُمْ** (and your fasting is better for you).

10. When is agreement not required?

Agreement between the **Mubtada** and the **Khabar** in gender and in number is required under the following conditions:

- When the **Khabar** is a **mushtaqq** or an **Ism Mansub**, as in **زَيْدٌ مَدِينِيٌّ** and **زَيْدٌ عَالِمٌ**
- When the **Khabar** contains a pronoun referring back to the **Mubtada**

And in the following cases agreement is not required:

- When the **Khabar** is an **Ism ut Tafdeel** used with **مِنْ**, as in **سَلَمَى أَجْوَدُ مِنْ أُخْتِهَا**
- When the **Khabar** is a form particular to the feminine, as in **حَامِلٌ** and **حَائِضٌ**
- When the **Khabar** is a form common to both masculine and feminine

Summary

1. Every word of the Qur'an is a Kalimah, that is, either an Ism, or a Fi'l, or a Harf.
2. Four aspects of any noun must be known: jins, 'adad, wus'at and I'raab.
3. The state of raf' is the subject state, the state of nasb the object state, and the state of jarr expresses annexation or possession.
4. A Ghayr Munsarif never takes Tanween or a kasrah, but with al- it does accept a kasrah in the state of jarr.
5. Nouns ending in an Alif Maqsurah, such as Musa and 'Isa, are written and read alike in all three states.
6. A noun standing alone is called Mufrad, and a combination of two or more words is a Murakkab.
7. A Murakkab from which the idea is not complete is a Murakkab Naqis; one from which it is complete is a Murakkab Tamm, that is, a Jumlah.
8. A Jumla Ismiyyah begins with an Ism and a Jumla Fi'liyyah with a Fi'l.
9. Ism + Ism and Ism + Fi'l form a Jumla Ismiyyah, while Fi'l + Ism forms a Jumla Fi'liyyah.
10. A Jumla Ismiyyah has two parts: the Muftada (Musnad Ilayh) and the Khabar (Musnad).
11. Arabic has no separate word for "is" or "are"; the joining of a Ma'rifah with a Nakirah produces that sense of itself.
12. The four conditions: the Muftada Ma'rifah and the Khabar Nakirah, both Marfoo', both of the same gender, and both of the same number.
13. Five categories of Ma'rifah serve the Muftada: Ism ul 'Alam, Ism ud Dameer, Ism ul Isharah, Ism ul Mawsul and Mu'arraf bil Lam.
14. When masculine and feminine together form the Muftada, the Khabar comes in the masculine, though the number is still observed.
15. A single Muftada may have more than one Khabar, joined by a waw or left unjoined.
16. Sometimes a Nakirah Makhsusah also becomes the Muftada, as in **طِفْلٌ صَغِيرٌ جَمِيلٌ**.
17. The Khabar is sometimes Mufrad and sometimes a whole sentence; if a sentence, it must contain a pronoun referring back to the Muftada.
18. The Khabar is sometimes a Zarf or a Jarr Majroor, as in **زَيْدٌ فِي الدَّارِ**.
19. If a Zarf or Jarr Majroor comes at the beginning of a sentence, it is the Khabar Muqaddam and the noun after it the Muftada Mu'akhkhar.
20. Agreement is not required when the Khabar is an Ism ut Tafdeel used with مَنْ, or a form particular to the feminine.

Exercise

1. Write the four aspects of an Ism and state the forms of each.

2. Explain the difference between Mufrad and Murakkab, and give two examples each of Murakkab Naqis and Murakkab Tamm.
3. Define Jumla Ismiyyah and Jumla Fi'liyyah, and write all three ways of forming a sentence.
4. Define the Muftada and the Khabar, and explain why they are called Musnad Ilayh and Musnad.
5. Set out all four conditions for forming a Jumla Ismiyyah in the form of a table.
6. Write the five categories of Ma'rifah available to the Muftada, with examples.
7. Separate the Muftada and Khabar in the following and analyse both: زَيْدٌ مُعَلِّمٌ , خَدِيجَةُ صَالِحَةٌ.
8. If the Muftada is dual, what will the Khabar be? Give one masculine and one feminine example.
9. Why does مَلَائِكَةٌ end in a round taa' although it is not feminine?
10. Write all three Jam' Mukassar forms of طَالِبٌ and state which of them is Ghayr Munsarif.
11. What is the ruling on the Khabar when masculine and feminine come together as the Muftada? Give two examples.
12. Write both ways in which a single Muftada may have more than one Khabar, with an example.
13. Explain the difference between Khabar Mufrad and Khabar Jumlah, and state the necessary condition for the Khabar Jumlah.
14. What are the Khabar Muqaddam and the Muftada Mu'akhkhar? Explain with an example.
15. What is the difference between a Zarf Laghw and a Zarf Mustaqirr?
16. In which cases is agreement between the Muftada and the Khabar not required?

سُبْحَانَكَ اللَّهُمَّ وَبِحَمْدِكَ، أَشْهَدُ أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا أَنْتَ، أَسْتَغْفِرُكَ وَأَتُوبُ إِلَيْكَ

اللَّهُمَّ صَلِّ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا صَلَّيْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ

اللَّهُمَّ بَارِكْ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا بَارَكْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ